

Page 02 — Articles /articles.html

Audited: 7 September 2026 · repository `bccody03/blog-site` @ `main` `32fcad7` (merged into the audit branch)
Method: headless Chromium at 1440×900 / 820×1180 / 390×844 with the real webfonts served locally and a 14-post feed injected · computed-style and geometry extraction · WCAG contrast from measured colour pairs
Status: Audit only — **no code changes applied.**

7

CHANGES PROPOSED

1

HIGH

4

MEDIUM

2

LOW

58

UX score, out of 100. Up sharply from the homepage's 45 — the H1, the intro copy and the removal of pagination are all real improvements and they show. What holds it back is that the page now has fourteen items to present and a 720px column to present them in.

Site-wide status, checked against current `main`

Fixed since the page-01 report, verified here: **H2** real buttons now exist (`.sub-submit` at 136×46) · **X3** the Substack iframe is gone, replaced with a native `.sub-form` in your own palette · **T10** every image carries `width / height`, logo is 60×60 at 4 KB · **C5** post titles are `h3` .

Still open, confirmed again here and cross-referenced rather than re-argued:

ID	Finding	Measured on this page
R1	Critical. At 390px the nav clips — Reflect, About and Substack render off-screen, no hamburger, no visible scrollbar	<code>clientW 170 · scrollW 386</code>
V1	One breakpoint; <code>.wrap</code> caps at 720px	<code>wrap 720px on a 1440px viewport</code>
R3	Focus ring is the browser default; no <code>:focus-visible</code> anywhere	<code>outline: auto 1px rgb(16,16,16)</code>
H5	Card CTAs bottom-misaligned	row 1 bottoms at y=928, 928, 904

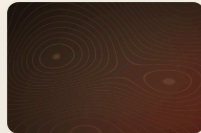
← HOME

Essays on discipline, love and living with intention

Everything I've written, newest first — free to read.

Everything I've written lives here: essays on discipline, love, and building a life with intention, written from inside the work rather than after it. Some are about relationships and rebuilding after a hard season. Some are about the small daily habits that quietly turn things around. A few are just honest notes on where I am right now.

I publish most weeks. Start with the newest, or scan down for whatever you're carrying at the moment — every piece is free, and each one links straight through to the full essay.



JANUARY 10, 2026

The Discipline You Keep When Nobody Is Watching

I used to think discipline was a thing you summoned on the hard days. It is not — it...



FEBRUARY 11, 2026

What I Got Wrong About Leading With Love

I used to think discipline was a thing you summoned on the hard days. It is not — it...



MARCH 12, 2026

A Week of Writing Everything Down

I used to think discipline was a thing you summoned on the hard days. It is not — it...

[Read on Substack →](#)

1440×900. The H1, subtitle and intro copy are all new and all work. Below them, fourteen essays are being presented in 207px-wide cards inside a 720px column, with 360px of empty margin on each side.

A. The new problem: fourteen items, one narrow column

U1 Removing pagination fixed the SEO and created a mobile scroll of 8.8 screens HIGH

MEASURED

		document height	viewports	
desktop	1440	2,955 px	3.28	
tablet	820	2,944 px	2.49	
mobile	390	7,456 px	8.83	← with a 14-post feed

Deleting pagination was the right call and I recommended it — it turned three uncrawable JS states into one URL containing every essay. But it was an SEO fix, and it landed on a layout that was never designed to hold the whole archive.

On a phone each card is a full-width 342px block with a 228px-tall thumbnail, so one essay costs roughly 400px of scroll. Fourteen of them is nearly nine screens. And the archive grows every time you publish — at thirty essays this is an eighteen-screen page.

FIX — KEEP THE ONE URL, SHRINK THE ROW

- **Drop thumbnails on mobile.** `@media (max-width: 560px) { .post-thumb { display: none } }.` That alone takes the page from 8.8 screens to roughly 4. The titles are set in Fraunces and carry the row perfectly well on their own — see **U3**, where the images are actively hurting.
- **Compact rows below the first few.** Show the newest three as full cards, then switch to a dense list — date, title, one line — for everything older. A reader scanning for something specific wants a list, not a gallery.
- **Do not reintroduce pagination.** If the length becomes genuinely unmanageable, use a "show older essays" button that appends — one URL, all content in the DOM after one click, and crawlers still see everything in the initial HTML once **T2**'s prerender lands.

B. Visual system

U2 207px cards on a 1440px screen MEDIUM → site-wide **V1**

Measured: `.wrap` = 720px, three cards across, **207px each**, thumbnails at 207×138. The archive is the page that most needs width — it is a grid of images and titles — and it gets the same column as a privacy policy.

Card titles wrap to three lines at this width ("The Discipline You Keep When Nobody Is Watching" takes three), which is what makes the row look cramped and what causes **H5**'s ragged bottoms to be so visible.

The **V1** fix — `max-width: 1100px` above 1280px — takes these cards to roughly 340px, drops most titles to two lines, and makes the thumbnails real images. Nothing else on this page needs to change for it to look substantially better.

U3 Fourteen thumbnails, four aspect ratios, no unifying treatment MEDIUM

MEASURED — EVERY THUMBNAIL RENDERS AT 207×138 (3:2) VIA OBJECT-FIT: COVER

Natural size	Ratio	What it is	Result at 3:2
1600×1000	1.60	dark abstract	near-native crop, fine
900×1200	0.75	portrait photograph	centre-cropped to landscape; most of the frame discarded
192×192	1.00	cream app icon	upscaled past its native width; soft
480×640	0.75	portrait photograph	same crop problem

This was V4 on the homepage with three cards. Here it repeats fourteen times down a single column, and the tonal swing — dark, bright, cream, dark — is what the eye tracks instead of the titles. In the screenshot above, your attention goes to the middle card. Not because that essay is better, but because that image is brighter.

FIX

On an archive I would now argue harder for the second option than I did on the homepage: **remove the thumbnails and let the titles carry it**. Fourteen Fraunces headlines with dates, in a clean column, would look more considered than fourteen mismatched Substack cover images — and it fixes U1 at the same time.

If you keep them, apply a warm duotone or a low-opacity --accent overlay with mix-blend-mode: multiply so whatever arrives from the feed resolves into your palette.

U4 Two text styles still fail contrast MEDIUM → V2

The V2 fix was applied to link colours but not to --accent-soft where it is used for text. Measured against --bg #f7f1e6 :

Element	Colour	Size	Ratio	Needs
.post-meta — every article date	#c46a4f	12.2px	3.38	4.5
.eyebrow — "← HOME"	#c46a4f	13.1px	3.38	4.5

Interesting detail from the sweep: the <a> inside the eyebrow renders at #9a3b27 and measures 6.17 — it passes. So the link is readable and the wrapper it sits in is not. Two colours, one component.

Fix as before: use --accent #9a3b27 for both, or darken --accent-soft to about #a8532f . This same pair fails on book , reflect , about and 404 — one token change closes all five pages.

C. Layout detail

U5 Card CTAs are still bottom-misaligned LOW → H5

```
row 1 — .post-more bottoms: 928, 928, 904 24px ragged
row 2 — .post-more bottoms: 1318, 1294, 1294
```

Cards are equal height (360px) but contents are top-aligned, so a two-line title leaves its CTA 24px higher than a three-line neighbour. With fourteen cards the raggedness now repeats down five rows instead of appearing once.

```
.post-body { display: flex; flex-direction: column; height: 100%; }
.post-more { margin-top: auto; }
```

Two lines, still. This is the cheapest visible improvement on the page.

U6 No visual break between rows of five LOW

Fourteen identical cards in an unbroken grid give a reader no sense of progress or position. On desktop that is five rows with nothing marking where they are; on mobile it is fourteen identical blocks.

Cheap fix: group by year or month with a small label between groups — you already have the dates, and `.section-label` already exists as a style. It turns an undifferentiated wall into something scannable, and it makes the archive feel like a body of work accumulating rather than a list.

U7 What the last pass got right — protect it KEEP

- **The H1 and intro.** "Essays on discipline, love and living with intention" at 54.4px Fraunces, with two paragraphs of real framing under it. The page now says what it is before it starts listing. This was **C15/C19** and the execution is better than what I proposed.
- **"Everything I've written lives here"** as the opening line of the intro — that is **C36** answered before I raised it, and it is the right sentence for a domain that wants to stop describing itself as a mirror.
- **The native subscribe form.** 460px total, 314px input plus a 136×46 button, centred, in your own palette. It looks like the site now.
- **Heading tree is clean:** H1 → H2 → H3 ×14. No skips, no reversals.
- **Hover craft** — 4px card lift, 1.05 thumbnail scale, title recolour — all still intact.

Evidence log

Check	Result
Page depth	1440 → 2,955px (3.28 folds) · 820 → 2,944px (2.49) · 390 → 7,456px (8.83)
Content column	<code>.wrap</code> 720px at every viewport ≥561px · cards 207×360

Thumbnails	All 207×138 (3:2, <code>object-fit: cover</code>) from 1.60, 0.75, 1.00 and 0.75 ratio sources
Card CTA alignment	928 / 928 / 904 — 24px ragged, repeating per row
Contrast	<code>.post-meta</code> 3.38 · <code>.eyebrow</code> 3.38 · <code>.eyebrow a</code> 6.17 ✓ · <code>.archive-sub</code> 5.52 ✓ · <code>excerpt</code> 5.52 ✓ · <code>titles</code> 13.62 ✓
Buttons	<code>.sub-submit</code> 136×46 ✓ — a real target, above the 44px floor
Mobile nav	clientW 170 · scrollW 386 · 3 items off-screen
Focus ring	<code>outline: auto 1px rgb(16,16,16)</code> , no box-shadow
Images	All carry <code>width / height</code> ✓

UI page 02 of 7 complete.

blakecody.com UI change log · generated 7 September 2026